simreal

Financial AI will be trained in our markets

RL environments and human intelligence for financial AI

Founded	Y Combinator	Raising
September 2026	Winter 2027	Seed round

Overview

RL environments and human intelligence for AI that does financial work

Revenue

$250K / month

Data sales in September 2026, about $3M a year; no outside capital

Flagship

Xitadel

Quant research on stocks, baskets and options, graded by the market

Buyers

Three segments

Frontier labs, financial firms and vertical AI startups

Team

Quant founders, all 21

Cambridge, LSE and Duke mathematics
Jane Street, Citadel, Optiver, Millennium

Supply

7,000+ signed up

Traders and experts for paid data work; 600+ GitHub stars on our benchmarks

Market

$2.8B a year

Spent by investment managers on alternative data in 2025 (Neudata)

How it fits

Funds already buy their edge as data. We sell the environments and trader data that AI needs to do financial work, and the market grades every result.

Team

Four 21-year-old founders. Together they turned down $1M+ in first-year pay to build SimReal

Jane Street · CITADEL · millennium · Optiver · University of Cambridge

Charles CEO · 21

Employee #1 at United Stables, building it from scratch to $1.5B+. Listed on Binance within a month.

Led institutional partnerships with YZi Labs, SIG, DRW and Wintermute

Only intern on HSBC's HKD stablecoin project, working on HKMA compliance

Hedge fund intern, Citadel

LSE, Mathematics
USAMO qualifier

Henry CTO · 21

Cambridge Mathematics, St John's College, First Class with Scholarship

Youngest researcher at the Cambridge AI research center, under Prof. Po-Ling Loh (IMS Fellow)

Ex-quant at Jane Street, Citadel and Optiver

Top 30 worldwide, Cambridge STEP maths competition (~IMO Medalist level)
British Physics Olympiad Top Gold

Amaris COO · 21

Data scientist, Millennium Hong Kong

First graduate hire on Millennium's alternative-data team

Co-organized Plug and Play's first Hong Kong event, with HKSTP (200+ attendees)

Duke, Mathematics and Statistics

James CPO · 21

Quant trading at Optiver

Asset management at Fidelity

Equity research at Jefferies

LSE, Mathematics
AMC: global top 1%
British Mathematical Olympiad: Gold

Problem

Agents are moving into financial work. Their backtests lie

	Looks right		What actually happens
Trading	Profitable in backtest	→	Loses money live
Research	Signal looks strong	→	Overfit to the past
Forecasting	Analysis sounds right	→	Outcome proves it wrong
Self-improvement	Score goes up	→	By fooling the backtest

6/32 In a live trading contest (Nof1's Alpha Arena), frontier models made money in only 6 of 32 runs

A backtest you can fool will lie to you. A self-improving agent just gets better at fooling it

Source: Nof1, Alpha Arena (May 2026).

Why now

Agents are entering finance and improving themselves. Both need a test they cannot fake

What changed in 2026	What we have built
Funds are handing research to agents An AI-agent hedge fund raised a $100M seed Abundance, Apr 2026	**Xitadel: agents do quant research** Stocks, baskets and options, graded by the market
Funds buy their edge as data Investment managers spent $2.8B on alternative data in 2025, up 17% Neudata, Feb 2026	**Environments licensed like datasets** Exclusive to one fund, priced at 4–5x
AI is improving itself An agent rewrote its own code and improved 7 times in 8 days Weco AIDE², Sep 2026	**A test it cannot fool** We try to break every environment before anyone trains on it

Our position Environments gate self-improvement. **Most neolabs have no revenue; we sell $250K of data a month**

Sources: Abundance (Bloomberg, Apr 2026); Neudata, The state of the alternative data market in 2026 (Feb 2026); Weco AI, arXiv 2609.26457; Deedy Das neolab list (May 2026).

Solution

A loop that turns real outcomes into better agents, with AI inside it from day one



What's different

Today

Experts grade by judgment; evaluations check a known answer

SimReal

The market grades. Every order is matched the way an exchange would match it, and we try to break each environment before anyone trains on it.

Training infrastructure: more per unit of compute

1/4	+64%	−1/3
the time per practice run	scored attempts, same compute	time spent saving checkpoints

Loop figures come from separate internal tests and should not be added together.

Product

Environments and trader data for financial AI. The market or the real outcome grades every result

FLAGSHIP · QUANT RESEARCH

Xitadel

open source

An agent explores private, anonymized market data, writes trading strategies and tests them against bots that simulate other market participants.

What the agent works with

- Stocks
- ETF-style baskets
- Options
- Simulated market participants
- A backtester
- A visualizer to inspect every trade

Scored by

P&L on a withheld trading day, penalized for drawdown and low Sharpe.
Each run yields a verifiable reward and a full research trajectory.

Forecasting

Future Prediction

Agents forecast events with search and prediction-market tools, scored when the outcome is known. Copying the frozen market forecast earns zero.

Human intelligence

Trader data

Demonstrations and explanations from professional and retail traders: how they research and trade

Also built

Accounting (Month-End Close) · ML research (MLBench)
Maths, reasoning and software benchmarks

600+ **GitHub stars across our open benchmarks**

Month-End Close is private. GitHub stars as of October 2026. We are extending the same approach to more financial work.

Inside Xitadel

Explore, code, then a private held-out day. Scored on P&L against the best human strategy

01

Explore

Private, anonymized order books and trades for stocks, baskets and options, with position limits and product rules

→

02

Code

The agent writes a Python strategy, backtests it and uses a visualizer to inspect trades and fix failures

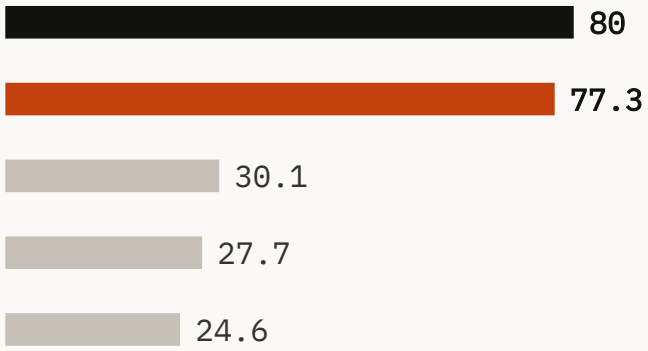
→

03

Held-out test

Run step by step on a private test day, against bots that simulate other market participants

Published results · score out of 100; human reference = 80



Score and controls

Score	max(0, P&L − 0.1 × max drawdown) × Sharpe factor (0.8–1.0) Rescaled: best human = 80, twice it = 100 (the cap)
Selection	Tasks fixed before any model was scored; reserve test days replace any that become public
Audit	Full results hash-committed (SHA-256); the training reward is separate from this score

Published results are on the seven v1 tasks. Human reference: the strongest real strategy on each task from IMC Prosperity, a trading competition.

Traction

$250K of data sales in September 2026. About $3M a year, with no outside capital

Revenue

$250K

In September 2026

About $3M a year at this rate

4 paying customers: data suppliers and AI startups

Largest: a data supplier serving frontier labs, with a $100K order

Revenue mix	**60% agent trajectories** 35% reasoning traces and rubrics from quant traders; 5% verified RL tasks
Day 14	**7 environments shipped** Trading, forecasting, accounting, ML research, maths, reasoning, software
Training	**Training loop running end to end** Models train on past trading days and are scored on a withheld day
Supply	**7,000+ signed up for paid data work** 200K+ students and alumni of 21 top universities in reach
Pipeline	**2 frontier labs in talks** For environment and data contracts

About $3M a year = September 2026 revenue x 12. Orders are placed on demand today; we are moving them to subscriptions.

Why us

An expert can't grade a trade. Only the market can

01

An expert can't grade a trade

Data vendors sell expert time, but no expert can say whether a strategy will make money. Our environments match every order the way an exchange would.

02

Markets have no answer key

Evaluation companies grade against a known answer. In trading and forecasting the answer arrives with the outcome, and it shifts as others copy what works.

03

A neutral supplier

Funds won't hand their data to a lab, and labs would rather buy finance expertise than build it. We can license an environment to one fund at 4–5x, the way funds buy data.

04

Revenue funds speed

We sell $250K of data a month and have 7,000+ people signed up to write tasks, more than a small team or an in-house group can match.

Landscape

Quant environment startups	EdotEnv (YC S26)	Quant research environments for labs
Expert-data vendors	Mercor, Surge, Scale, AfterQuery	Expert time and contractor-built environments
Finance evaluation	Halluminate, Vals	Banking and private-equity work, graded against known answers
SimReal	**Environments and trader data**	**Graded by the market or the real outcome; neutral to funds and labs**

In short — They sell hours or answer keys; **we sell results the market grades**

Human intelligence

Traders and quants show agents how the work is done. The market checks the result

Practitioners in our R&D have worked at top trading firms and markets, including

Jane Street · CITADEL | Securities · Optiver · Polymarket

Professional and retail traders

Demonstrations and explanations of how they research and trade

→ **Data for agents that trade**

Quant, maths and finance talent

Students and alumni of 21 top universities

→ **Data for agents that do financial research**

200K+	**Students and alumni we can reach**	7,000+	**Signed up for paid data work**	21	**Top universities**

Students and alumni of

Harvard University · Stanford University · MIT · University of Oxford · University of Cambridge · Princeton University · Yale University · Berkeley University of California · 清華大學 · Columbia University · The University of Chicago · Duke University

Logos show where practitioners have worked or studied; no endorsement implied.

Market

Funds already buy their edge as data. AI that does financial work needs it too

Financial firms: market data and analysis, 2025

$49.2B / year

A record, up 6.5% (Burton-Taylor)

Investment managers: alternative data, 2025

$2.8B / year

Up 17% in a year (Neudata)

$2B+

Mercor gross run-rate:
June 2026

→ **Labs pay billions for expert data**

$100M+

AfterQuery run-rate, within about
15 months of founding

→ **New data vendors scale fast**

4–5x

Exclusive environments cost 4–5x
non-exclusive ones (Epoch AI)

→ **Exclusivity is priced like data**

Sources: Burton-Taylor (TP ICAP), Financial Market Data/Analysis 2026; Neudata, The state of the alternative data market in 2026; Mercor (TechCrunch, Jul 2026); AfterQuery (Dealroom, Apr 2026); Epoch AI (Jan 2026). Run-rates are gross.

Business model

Three buyers, one set of environments. All three already buy our data

01

Frontier AI labs

They buy

Environments, trajectories and expert data to train and test their models

How we charge

Per environment and per task, on quarterly contracts

Estimated price

$300K–$1M+

Per lab, per quarter

Market rates: $200–$2,000 a task (Epoch AI)

02

Financial firms

They buy

Environments to train and test agents before they touch real money

How we charge

A paid pilot, then an annual licence; exclusive at 4–5x

Estimated price

$200K–$800K

Per firm, per year

Pilot: $50K–$150K. Hedge funds and prop shops first; then banks, asset managers, exchanges

03

Vertical AI startups

They buy

Data and environments to train finance agents and prove they work

How we charge

Data subscriptions and environment licences

Pricing

Subscription

Per dataset or environment

Several already buy our data

Recurring revenue from licences, data subscriptions and task updates; every new model needs new tasks

Estimates, not signed prices. Lab prices are market rates from Epoch AI interviews (January 2026). Financial-firm prices are our assumptions.

The round

Raising a seed round to scale financial environments, trader data and delivery

Raising

Seed

Y Combinator

Winter 2027

Three directions, each with a milestone →

01

Financial environments

Take Xitadel's playbook to more financial work

Where the money goes

Engineers · Practitioner reviewers

Milestone

10+ financial environments

02

Self-improvement

Scale the training loop to larger models and domains

Where the money goes

Compute · Researchers

Milestone

Training loop on open-weight large models

03

Delivery

Sign labs and financial firms directly, on subscriptions

Where the money goes

Delivery team · Sales

Milestone

20 customers

business@simreal.co